

2. Which users should be allowed to install new software? – Installer rules can be used to block installation of programs in a certain directory or coming from a certain vendor. Say, if the boss doesn't want any software from Adobe, one rule is all that's needed.
3. Which versions of applications should be allowed? – Suppose you use O&O Defragmenter and you want only versions 10.0 and above to be installed on any computer, a rule in AppLocker will see to that.

While AppLocker certainly makes sense in the corporate environment where program versions and permissions are important, it can also be useful for advanced users in a home environment. While it's available for Windows 7 Ultimate and Windows 7 Enterprise, Microsoft has included it only in the Enterprise edition of Windows 8. As a home user, you can enforce some rules on your computer without AppLocker too. At the least you can simulate the "Path" rules using NTFS permissions.

Windows To Go

To have a 'Live Linux' is no big deal. Download it, burn it, it runs. For Windows, it would be a herculean task if you could do it without any tools. There already are tools like BartPE and WinBuilder which allow you to create your own Live Windows DVD or USB, but they're not supported by Microsoft. They're more of a hobbyist's tools, and enterprises would rather not bet on a technology unsupported by Microsoft due to risks associated with such deployments. Don't be disheartened because Windows 8 Enterprise has an alternative – Windows To Go – which lets offices boot from USB disk drives (including external hard disks). Enterprises can distribute their preconfigured corporate setup on a USB drive with all the security and restrictions they want and that too with official support! Unfortunately, it's not for home users. That said, one of the most exciting features of Windows To Go is its behavior upon removal of the USB

NOTE

1. AppLocker can be started by typing 'gpedit.msc' in the search box and then navigating to Local Computer Policy > Computer Configuration > Windows Settings > Security Settings > Application Control Policies in the Group Policy Editor window.

2. If you haven't used AppLocker yet, then let it be known: just creating rules won't do anything. You need to first enforce the rules. To do this, right-click 'AppLocker' on the left pane and select properties.